

Our System: Nintendo Switch

System Description:

A video game console developed by Nintendo, capable of being a portable and home console with its dock feature that is connected to the tv. It is bought containing 2 controllers called joy cons reaching to about 4.5 inches which can be played away from the console or clipped onto the sides for personal play as well as a touchscreen feature on the screen part of the console. Its main and only use is for playing video games which are either downloaded using wi-fi or game cards which are inserted into the system.

Representative Tasks:

1. Turn on the console.
2. Attach the joy-con remotes to the console and enter the home screen.
3. Change of the device to the other theme
4. Using the touch-screen, follow "Pokémon UNITE News"
5. Show me where to purchase "Super Mario Bros 3"
6. Play the game for a short period of time; between 1-3 minutes.
(researcher will have select game(s) picked)
7. Please make the Switch sit vertically like this. [Show them]
8. Find and locate the memory card.
9. Mirror the switch to the TV
10. Remove the joy-con controllers from the switch and power them off.

Questionnaire:

Pre-Study:

1. Have you owned or played on a mobile gaming device before? If so, which devices?
2. Do you know what a joy-con remote is?
3. When using a mobile gaming device are there any features that matter most or stand out to you?
4. When using a touchscreen device, are there any qualities you look for?

5. How do you feel about a system offering customizable themes? For example, changing your web browser color on chrome.

6. Do you consider the durability and lifespan of a mobile device and its parts before purchasing?

Post-Study Questions:

1. How did you feel about this Nintendo Switch?
2. Overall, was there a feature you liked the most?
3. Was there a feature you disliked the most or had trouble with?
4. Are there any improvements you would suggest to make the Nintendo Switch better?
5. What was your impression of the controller's comfort and responsiveness during the session?
6. Is there any way you think the joy-con could be improved?
7. How would you rate the overall user-friendliness of the Nintendo Switch based on your experience with the tasks?
8. Was there any aspect of the console's interface that you found confusing or challenging to navigate?
9. Did you find the touchscreen accurate to where you intended to press?
10. How would you describe the ease of inserting and removing game cards from the console?
11. How do you feel about the size and shape of the game card?
12. How did the buttons feel when being pressed? [Hand them a joy-con again if needed]
13. In your opinion, how would you describe the quality and durability of Nintendo Switch's parts compared to other portable devices you've used?
14. How was the difficulty to locate and use the kickstand? Do you have any comments about that part of the Switch?
15. Was it difficult to remove the joy-con remotes from the console?
16. Did the console go into its docking station easily?

Script:

Hello, my name is [name of researcher]. I am a student at the University of Michigan. First, I'd like to thank you for your time and participation in this study.

We have chosen to study and re-design the Nintendo Switch and today we will be asking you to explore the console and perform a series of tasks followed by a few questions. Before we begin, we have a few questions about your experience with the Nintendo Switch or a similar system to start the study.

Have you owned or played on a mobile gaming device before? If so, which devices?

When using a mobile gaming device, are there any features that matter most or stand out to you?

When using a touchscreen device, are there any qualities you look for?

How do you feel about a system offering customizable themes? For example, changing your web browser color on chrome.

Do you consider the durability and lifespan of a mobile device and its parts before purchasing?

**** End of pre-study questionnaire****

Thank you very much. Now we are going to move on to the next part of the study.

I am going to ask you to complete some tasks using the console. I will only tell you what to do, but not how to do it. Please keep in mind that we are not testing or judging you on your performance. Here's a switch with an account already created. Please briefly inspect it.
[Researcher hands them a Switch]

First, please turn on the console.

Now, please attach the joy-con remotes to the console and enter the home screen.

Thank you. Please go to the settings and change the theme of the device, then return to the home.

Next, using the touch-screen, please follow “Pokémon UNITE News” under News. When finished, please return to the home.

Please open the shop and locate the “Super Mario Bros 3” page

Now, insert a game card (researcher will select a game or give options) and play the game for about 1 to 3 minutes.

Thank you. See if you can prop the device like this (demonstrate as an example).

Try to locate the memory card slot.

Now, please connect the Switch to the TV using the dock.

Thank you. Lastly, remove the controllers from the switch and power them off.

****Start of post-study questionnaire****

How did you feel about the Nintendo Switch?

Overall, was there a feature you liked the most?

Was there a feature you disliked the most or had trouble with?

Are there any improvements you would suggest making the Nintendo Switch better?

What was your impression of the controller's comfort and responsiveness during the session?

Is there any way you think the joy-con could be improved?

Was it difficult to remove the joy-con remotes from the console?

How did the buttons feel when being pressed? [Hand them a joy-con again if needed]

Was there any aspect of the console's interface that you found confusing or challenging to navigate?

Did you find the touchscreen accurate to where you intended to press?

In your opinion, how would you describe the quality and durability of Nintendo Switch's parts compared to other portable devices you've used?

How was the difficulty to locate and use the kickstand? Do you have any comments about that part of the Switch?

How would you describe the ease of inserting and removing game cards from the console?

How do you feel about the size and shape of the game card?

Did the console go into its docking station easily?

How would you rate the overall user-friendliness of the Nintendo Switch based on your experience with the tasks?

****End of Post-study questionnaire****

Thank you once again for taking time to participate in this study. This was very helpful in showing us what improvements can be made to the device.